Per Diem Rates

1. Overview of Per Diem Policy

Larkspur Freight provides per diem allowances to cover meals and lodging for employees traveling on company business. Rates vary by region and are reviewed annually by the Finance Department. All per diem claims must be submitted via the LedgerEase portal within 10 business days of trip completion. Receipts are not required for standard per diem, but any expenses exceeding the daily cap must be pre-approved by a regional manager. The current policy is effective as of March 1, 2024.

2. Midwest Region Rates

For employees based in or traveling to the Midwest (including Chicago, St. Louis, and Des Moines offices):
• Lodging: $120 USD per night
• Meals: $55 USD per day
• Incidentals: $10 USD per day
Meal per diem is reduced by 40% on travel days shorter than 6 hours. Midwest rates are valid for up to 14 consecutive days; longer stays require VP approval. Approved vendors for direct billing include StayRight Hotels and MealMate.

3. West Coast Region Rates

West Coast offices (Seattle, Portland, San Francisco) have higher per diem rates due to local costs:
• Lodging: $165 USD per night
• Meals: $70 USD per day
• Incidentals: $15 USD per day
Employees must use the TripTrack app to log daily expenses. For trips exceeding 7 days, a 5% reduction applies to lodging per diem from day 8 onward. Only bookings through PacificStay and UrbanBite are eligible for direct billing.

4. Southern Region Rates

Southern region (Dallas, Atlanta, New Orleans):
• Lodging: $105 USD per night
• Meals: $48 USD per day
• Incidentals: $8 USD per day
Meal per diem is not provided if meals are included in conference fees or vendor packages. All claims must be approved by the Southern Regional Finance Lead (currently: Carla Mendez). Use the PerDiemPro tool for submission.

5. International Travel Allowances

For international assignments, per diem rates are set according to the Larkspur Freight International Table (see Finance SharePoint). Example rates:
• Canada: Lodging $140 CAD/night, Meals $65 CAD/day
• Mexico: Lodging $90 USD/night, Meals $40 USD/day

Currency conversion is handled by the ConvertaPay system at the daily rate. International per diem is capped at 21 days unless extended by the CFO.

6. Eligibility and Exceptions

Per diem is available to full-time and contract employees traveling more than 50 miles from their home office. Exceptions (e.g., for part-time staff or extended stays) require written approval from the Director of Finance. Per diem is not provided for remote work or virtual conferences. Any disputes or appeals must be submitted to the Per Diem Review Committee within 30 days of expense denial.

7. Deadlines and Submission Process

All per diem requests must be submitted within 10 business days post-travel via the designated regional tool (LedgerEase, TripTrack, or PerDiemPro). Late submissions are subject to a 15% reduction unless a waiver is granted by the Finance Department. Employees should retain travel itineraries for audit purposes for at least 18 months. Questions can be directed to per-diem@larkspurfreight.com.